

Case Study: UPI "Receive Money" Fraud

What's Going On:

UPI and online payment scams often rely on tricking people into thinking they're about to get money, when actually, they're about to lose it. Scammers play on misunderstandings around how payment apps work, especially catching people off guard.

Who's at Risk:

College students and young adults fall for this scam the most. They're usually looking to buy or sell used stuff—like electronics or textbooks—on online marketplaces.

How the Scam Works (Step-by-Step):

Let's say there's a college student, Rohan, trying to sell his old laptop online. Here's how the fraud typically unfolds:

First Contact: Someone messages Rohan, quickly agrees to his price, and says they'll send payment right away through a UPI app.

The Trap: Instead of actually sending money, the scammer sends Rohan a "Collect Request" to his UPI ID.

Creating Panic: The scammer calls, sounding urgent. They tell Rohan to open his UPI app, press "Pay," and enter his PIN—making it sound like this is just part of receiving the payment.

The Lie: The fraudster insists this is a required security step to get the money. Rohan, trusting the buyer and distracted by the rush, follows the instructions and enters his PIN.

What Happens Next:

Rohan doesn't get any money—instead, ₹15,000 vanishes from his account. The scammer immediately hangs up and blocks Rohan's number. Besides losing money, Rohan feels anxious and shaken, and his trust in digital payments is badly damaged.